

Document 24. Evaluation Toolkit

One-page reference of evaluation moves. For any 8-mark+ part, deploy at least two of the moves below to convert pure analysis into a substantive evaluation. The mark scheme awards Level 3 (evaluation) separately from Levels 1–2 (analysis).

Section A. The C-E-F Test for Policies

Constraint. Is the policy even available? (Fiscal space, debt limits, openness, political will, institutional capacity.)

Effectiveness. Does the policy achieve its intended outcome? Consider PED-PES, multiplier size, behavioural response, time lag.

Feasibility. Are unintended consequences acceptable? Consider equity, distortions, retaliation, asset bubbles, crowding-out.

Section B. Standard Evaluation Moves (apply at least two)

1. **Short-run vs long-run.** Does the conclusion change with the time horizon?
2. **Magnitude of effect.** Use PED-PES, multiplier, or elasticity logic to assess size.
3. **Conditional on assumptions.** Identify the assumption that, if broken, reverses the conclusion (e.g. small open vs large closed economy).
4. **Stakeholder split.** Who wins, who loses, by how much?
5. **Alternative policy.** Could a different policy deliver the same goal at lower cost?
6. **Unintended consequences.** Side-effects on other macro aims (inflation, BOT, inequality).
7. **Equity-efficiency trade-off.** Distinguish allocative gain from distributive harm.
8. **Context specificity.** Singapore's openness, MAS framework, fiscal rule. Always anchor to context.
9. **Policy mix.** No single policy is sufficient; combine demand-side, supply-side, and equity-distributive measures.
10. **Government failure risk.** Information failure, regulatory capture, deadweight.

Section C. The Two-Sided Paragraph Structure (TSP)

P — Point. State the evaluative judgement.

E — Explain. Economic reasoning for the judgement.

E — Example / Evidence. Anchor to context (Singapore data, case-study source).

L — Link. Return to the question; weigh against the opposing view.

Section D. Common Conclusions That Score Well

- “The policy is effective in the short run but insufficient in the long run without complementary supply-side measures.”

- “Given Singapore’s openness, the fiscal multiplier is small; therefore MP / supply-side measures dominate.”
- “The trade-off depends on which macro aim takes precedence; in 2024 the binding constraint is X, so policy Y is recommended.”
- “The benefits exceed the costs in aggregate, but the distributional impact warrants targeted transfers.”
- “A single instrument is inadequate; a coordinated mix of MAS exchange-rate appreciation, targeted fiscal transfers, and supply-side investment is optimal.”

Section E. Words That Signal Evaluation

Stance: however, on balance, ultimately, the more compelling argument is.

Magnitude: significant, marginal, decisive, modest, substantial.

Conditionality: provided that, only if, depending on, conditional on.

Time: in the short run, in the long run, eventually, immediately.

Comparative: relative to, more than, less than, equally.

Synthesis: hence, therefore, overall, in conclusion, the net effect is.

Section F. Things to Avoid

- “It depends.” (Empty without specifying what it depends on.)
- Repeating analysis points instead of weighing them.
- Concluding with “both sides have merit” without taking a stance.
- Generic statements detached from question context.
- Listing every limitation; pick two and develop them.